

on certain days of the month. Bonus: your date will be impressed by your deep cultural appreciation.

3. **Sweat it out.** If you want to turn up the dial on physical activity, move some furniture. It may sound strange, but it's also surprisingly intimate to help a girl move her coffee table or a guy to rearrange his office. Something about it triggers that "nesting" instinct and tests some fundamental personality matches. I used to have these huge speakers that weighed way more than Linda did: 300 pounds each. I kept them on the first floor of my house, but one Friday night, I decided I wanted to put them up on the third floor. All my roommates were gone, so it was up to Linda and me. We heaved and pushed and cursed and carried those speakers up three flights of stairs. That was our Friday date night. We did it together and were proud of ourselves when we'd managed the impossible. I still remember collapsing onto the sofa once we were done, Linda and I sitting side by side, listening to music together. Somehow, moving furniture had become an event, a trial we had to work together to get through, and it strengthened the bond between us. Bonus: we didn't have to pay movers.
4. **Board it up.** Have a competitive streak? Pull out a couple of classic board games and challenge your date to a night of Monopoly or Balderdash. Today, many cities have board game cafés, where the cost of a coffee or beer will grant you access to stacks and stacks of games. It's good, cheap fun and you'll earn extra marks for creativity. Bonus: a chance to see whether your date has a competitive streak (which, I'd say, might be a good thing!).
5. **It's just brunch.** By now, you know not to waste money on lavish dinners. So why not go out for brunch or lunch instead? Fancy restaurants are far more affordable in the A.M.